

Management of Ankle sprain in Children's Emergency

Assess the type of Ankle sprain (Low or High)



Management:

1) Low Ankle sprain: Mild sprain, Minimal swelling, able to walk without a limp.

Management: **Jones bandage**, rest, analgesics, PE excuse.

No orthopedic follow. Advise to return to CE if pain persist beyond 10 days despite rest.

2) Low Ankle sprain with Moderate swelling, Able to walk but limping with pain.

Management: **Airboots or ankle Brace**, rest, analgesics, PE excuse. Follow up in Paediatric Orthopedics **at 4 weeks**

3) Low Ankle sprain with inability to bear weight on affected side or walk, All high Ankle sprains.

Management: **Airboots and Crutches** for initial few days till the pain/swelling subsides and allow weight bearing on affected side if not painful. Rest, analgesics, PE excuse and Paediatric Orthopedic follow-up **at 4 weeks**.

Costs of splints and Crutches which parents need to know and agree. (cost as of May 2025)

Airboots: 207 SGD

-Available at CE charged to bills, nurses do the sizing.

- If we have no stock and if its a weekday then sends to Health & U shop opp Kopitiam (Main Building Level 1)

Crutches: 35 SGD

-Available in CE. Nurses administer training for crutches.

Ankle Brace: Cost 65 SGD

Alternative to Airboots if the parents not keen for Airboots due to cost. Less support and cushion as compared to Airboots. **Please note Ankle braces should be used only for Injuries under “1” and not for “3”**.



If parents do not agree for splints (Airboots or Ankle brace for Type 2 Injuries or Airboots for Type 3) due to cost issues, then please apply below knee back slab and advise them the appointment will be after 4 weeks. If the back slab becomes loose, dirty or slip off before the appointment date they will have to return to CE for repeat of back slab (full A&E fees apply for return visit).

Health and U Shop:

Main Building Level 1 opposite Kopitiam

Timings: weekdays 9am to 6 pm.

Sats: 9-12 mid-day but usually only one person so can try but may not always be available.

If patient comes after office hours or weekends, then please ask parents to go to that shop the next working day.

We can help parents to recoup some cost of splint. If a memo for insurance is given, then please mention that patient was advised to use the Air boots/ Ankle brace/crutches. (as the case may be).

-Dr Sharad, Dr Rishi